



SCHUHPLATTLING

The *Schuhplattling* (shoe-slapping) dance which goes back to the 11th-14th centuries is the most well-known Bavarian dance. The man's slapping movement is said to mimic a species of bird which flaps its wings to attract a mate.



SANTA CLAUS IN BERGHOFEN

On the 5th of December at 8pm black hooded figures with long straw beards and bells attached to their stomachs meet in Berghofen. Until midnight they run through the town, bells clanging deafeningly, visiting the local farms to banish evil spirits.

CHURCH IN THE HILLS

The town of Berchtesgaden nestles among valleys and lakes with the magnificent Bavarian Alps as its backdrop. This region was once a separate little country, one of the smallest states in the Holy Roman Empire.



Wood chopping is a skilled and physically demanding task so lumberjacks must be exceptionally fit.



WOOD PULLING

During the autumn lumberjacks chop wood in the forests of the Allgau. The logs are stored high in the mountains and brought down to the valley when needed. The wood is transported by helicopter or by horse-drawn carriage, which is cheap, efficient, and much better for the environment!

